

BANDEEP SINGH



THE TARGET: Amarinder Singh faces Badal's wrath

former media advisor B.I.S. Chahal as the accused in the Ludhiana City Centre case. The Bureau claims to have recovered a pen drive from Delhi businessman Chetan Gupta, allegedly containing details of illegal pay-offs to Amarinder and his family.

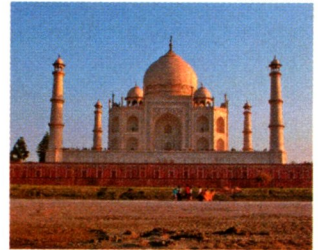
In an embarrassment to the government, the high court has granted anticipatory bail to Raninder, Raminder, Chahal and former minister Jagjit Singh, and has rapped the Bureau, calling its investigations smacking of political vendetta. "It's a serious setback to the Vigilance probe," admits advocate-general H.S. Mattewal.

The Badal Government has challenged the High Court's reprieve to the prime accused in the Supreme Court. "It's important to interrogate all the accused to unearth the scam," says Mattewal. The cat-and-mouse game between Badal and Amarinder may have just begun. **by Ramesh Vinayak**

No Wonder

DELHI An Internet campaign led by Swiss filmmaker Bernard Weber is underway to chronicle the "New Seven World Wonders" from a list of 21 man-made structures, in an "acceptable" state of preservation and completed by 2000. Short-listed monuments include the Taj Mahal, the Great Wall of China, the Acropolis in Greece, the

RAVI S. SAHANI



AT NO. 10: The Taj Mahal

Statue of Liberty in the US, apart from a host of others. The shortlist was chosen by a panel of architects in January 2006, out of 77 public nominations. As of June 1, around 60 million votes had been cast worldwide, of which only 3.1 per cent favoured the Taj, ranking it at number 10. **by Nandini Vals**

Politics of Vendetta

CHANDIGARH After attracting flak for its mishandling of the recent Sacha Sauda-Sikh crisis, the Shiromani Akali Dal-BJP Government has been tightening the screws on former Congress chief minister Captain Amarinder Singh, his family and close confidants in the Rs 2,000-crore Ludhiana City Centre scam, which is being investigated by the Vigilance Bureau.

Chief Minister Parkash Singh Badal's tactic, aimed at putting the sectarian

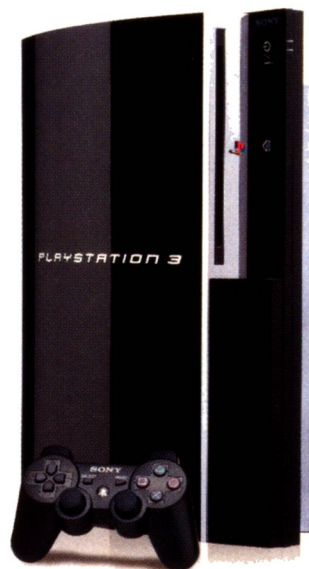
row behind and his sworn political foes in the dock, has backfired with the Punjab and Haryana Court rejecting the Vigilance Bureau's move to arrest them for custodial interrogation. While Bureau officials grilled Amarinder in Patiala on May 29—ostensibly to prepare fresh grounds for his arrest as he is on bail till July 31—the state investigating agency has named the Captain's son Raninder Singh, son-in-law Raminder Singh and

OBJECT OF DESIRE

Game Theory

SONY PS3 PLAYSTATION
Rs 39,990

The PS3's cell broadband engine, one of the most-advanced computer processors in the world, enables massive floating point calculation and the Blu-ray disc drive provides a high-definition next-generation gaming and movie experience. Its 50 GB data capacity for video game developers stores content up to five times the capacity of a DVD. The wireless controller allows gamers to physically turn, twist, and bank their controllers to command the on-screen action. PS3 also comes with an HDMI output for the best connection possible to high-definition displays. Its built-in network capability allows users to enjoy online games and browse the Net. Gaming just got a lot better.



Sub Shopping

DELHI Both the Indian and Pakistani navies are shopping for submarines to replace their ageing fleets. That was why German defence minister Franz Joseph Jung was here to meet his Indian counterpart A.K. Antony last week. The Indian Navy is looking at buying six submarines costing over Euro 3 billion from either Russia, Italy or France. Jung will later meet the Pakistani defence establishment for their three submarine requirement.

by Sandeep Unnithan